

The World is a Cultivating Field for the Hereafter

Learning Outcomes

After studying this unit, students will be able to:

- ❖ Understand and explain the meaning of the Hereafter.
- ❖ Develop the consciousness of the Hereafter and be able to act accordingly in their daily lives.
- ❖ Become a devout Muslim and live their lives according to the Islamic *Shariah*.

Belief in the Hereafter is one of the basic tenets of Islam. Belief in the Hereafter tells us that everything has specified time, after which it expires. In the same way, this world has specified time. When it will reach the end of its life, Hazrat Israfil عليه السلام (the Angel of Allah Almighty) will blow the trumpet by the command of Allah, as a result of which this whole world will come to an end. The sun and the Moon will fade away, the stars will collide with each other and scatter and the mountains will fly away like cotton wool. Man, animal and all creatures will perish.

After the total destruction of this world, by the command of Almighty Allah, Hazrat Israfil عليه السلام will blow the trumpet again, as a result of which all human beings will be resurrected and they will gather in a flat and plain surface where they will be held accountable for their deeds. This second world is called the Hereafter and it will start with the Day of Judgment.

The life of Hereafter and the Book of Deeds: Every action of a person which he/she performs in this world, whether it is small or big, good or bad, is recorded. Allah Almighty has appointed two of His angels to record the actions of human beings. They are called *Kiraman Katibeen* (the honourable scribes). They note down the deeds of human beings. On the Day of Resurrection, when a person will be held accountable before Allah Almighty, he will be given his book of deeds in his hand. Good deeds will be given in the right hand and bad deeds in the left hand or from behind the back of the person. The deeds of all human beings will be weighed there. The good deeds will be placed in one weighing pan of the balance while evil deeds will be placed in the other weighing pan of the balance. The one whose good deeds will weigh more than his evil deeds, he/she will be successful and he/she will be rewarded with Paradise. Paradise is the place of blessings and bounties where human beings will get what they want. Pain and suffering will not even pass by that place. On the other hand, the one whose evil deeds will weigh more than the good deeds, will fail and he will be thrown into the Hell. It is a very painful place where humans will be punished for their bad deeds.

Life of this World and Preparation for the Hereafter: Allah Almighty has created the life of this world as a source of preparation for the Hereafter. The life of this world is temporary, while the life of the Hereafter is eternal. The success of the Hereafter depends upon the deeds done in this world.

الدُّنْيَا مَزْرَعَةُ الْآخِرَةِ (الحديث)

Translation: The world is cultivating field of the Hereafter.

In other words, the example of the world is like that of a farming field. From the field, a farmer only reaps what he sows there. If a farmer sows wheat in the field, he will surely reap the wheat. If he plants a garden then he will surely reap the harvest in the form of fruits and flowers, but if anyone sows thorns and bushes, he will only reap thorns and bushes. Indeed! It is not possible to sow thorns and reap fruits and flowers.

In the same way, if a farmer works hard in the field, ploughs on time, sows seeds properly, irrigates on time and protects the field from harmful animals and insects then he will reap the fruits of his labour in the form of an abundant yield. But, if the farmer is lazy and careless in taking care of his field, he neither plough on time nor sows seeds properly and neither he waters on time nor he protects it, then he will not

be able to get any desired crop from the field. In the same way, if a person does good deeds in this world and protects himself from evil deeds, he will be successful on the Day of Resurrection and will certainly be rewarded for his good deeds. But whosoever does evil in this world, he will get punishment on the Day of Resurrection. Or if he has wasted his precious time in this world, he will not be able to get anything in the Hereafter. It is as if the life of this world has been granted to us for the preparation of the Hereafter.

Therefore, we should be aware of the importance of this worldly life. Life in this world is a blessing of Allah Almighty, which has been given to us for the preparation of the Hereafter. We should understand the importance of this blessing and must appreciate it. We must carry out good deeds in worldly life and stay away from the bad deeds. We should live according to the ways prescribed by Allah and His *Rasool* صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ so that we may get success and happiness in the Hereafter.

It is learnt from this unit that

Belief in the Hereafter is one of the basic tenets of Islam, according to which one day this world and all the things exist in it will perish. Then, another world will be recreated in which human beings will be resurrected, and on that day their deeds will be weighed. Whosoever has more good deeds will go to Paradise, which is the place of blessings and comforts and whosoever has more bad deeds will go to Hell which is the most painful place.

Activity for the students

Write two sentences about 'The world is Cultivating Field of the Hereafter' and read them aloud in front of the class.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. What will happen after Hazrat Israfil عليه السلام blows the trumpet for the first time?
2. What are the duties of *Kiraman Katibeen* (the honourable scribes)?
3. Why is this worldly life given to us?
4. What will be done with the records of deeds on the Day of Judgment?
5. How can the success and happiness in the Hereafter be achieved?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. On the Day of Judgment, Paradise will be rewarded to:

(A) Disbelievers	(B) Muslims
(C) Hypocrites	(D) Polytheists
2. On the Day of Judgment, the trumpet will be blown for the second time by:

(A) Angel Jibrail عليه السلام	(B) Angel Izrail عليه السلام
(C) Angel Israfil عليه السلام	(D) Angel Mikail عليه السلام
3. On the Day of Judgment, People of paradise will be given their record of deeds:

(A) In the right hand	(B) In the left hand
(C) In both hands	(D) From behind the back
4. Number of Angels, Allah has appointed for recording the deeds of a human being are:

(A) Two	(B) Three
(C) Four	(D) Five

5. The world is like a:

- (A) Factory
(C) Market

- (B) Farming field
(D) Gathering

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. Hazrat Israfil عليه السلام will blow the trumpet by the order of _____.
2. The honourable scribes note down man's good and bad deeds in _____.
3. _____ present in these accounts of deeds will be weighed.
4. World is _____ for the Hereafter.
5. All the human beings will be resurrected on the Day of Judgment by the order of _____.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. Belief in the Hereafter is one of the basic tenets of Islam.	☐	☐
2. Hazrat Mikail عليه السلام will blow the trumpet in the Hereafter.	☐	☐
3. Paradise is a place full of blessings and bounties.	☐	☐
4. Life of this world is forever.	☐	☐
5. Anyone who performed good deeds in this world will enter Paradise.	☐	☐

Instructions for the teachers

Narrate the sayings and quotations of the saints and scholars to the students in such a way that it yields consciousness of the Hereafter in them, and they make it a part of their lives.

Obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ and its Importance

Learning Outcomes

After studying this unit, students will be able to:

- ❖ Understand the purpose of obedience to the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ and write it down.
- ❖ Describe the importance of obeying the Nabi Karim ﷺ.

Meaning of *Ita'at-e-Rasool* ﷺ (Obedience to the Nabi Karim ﷺ)

‘اطاعت’ (Ita'at) is a word of Arabic language which refers to obeying and complying. According to the Islamic teachings, believing in the *Nabuwwat* of the Nabi Karim ﷺ and obeying his orders and instructions is as important as believing in Allah. Both are compulsory. The fact is that obedience to Allah is not possible without obeying the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ.

Significance of the obedience to the Nabi Karim ﷺ: The Holy Quran is a comprehensive book of Almighty Allah. In which he has prescribed *Salat* (Namaz), *Saum* (Saum), *Zakat* (Charity), *Hajj* (Pilgrimage) and *Jihad* etc. a clear method and complete explanation for their observance have not been mentioned in it. The method of performing these acts of worship have been explained by the Nabi Karim ﷺ through his words and deeds. This is why Allah has made it obligatory for Muslims to obey the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ. Without obeying the Nabi Karim ﷺ, neither the commands of the Holy Quran can be understood nor can they be followed correctly. Therefore, in the Holy Quran, Almighty Allah has ordered the Muslims to obey the Nabi Karim ﷺ along with obeying Him. As Allah says in the Quran:



يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَأَطِيعُوا الرَّسُولَ

Translation: O believers! Obey Allah and obey His *Rasool*. [Surah Al-Nisa: 59]

In another Ayat, Allah Almighty states:

Translation: Whosoever obeys the *Rasool* (ﷺ), has truly obeyed Allah.

[Surah Al-Nisa: 80]

It is explained in several Ayaat of the Holy Quran that no one can be a true *Momin* (believer) until he acts in accordance with the decisions made by the Nabi Karim ﷺ in all the matters of his life. Similarly, in the Holy Quran, the obedience to the Nabi Karim ﷺ has been ascribed as a great success as well as a reason of entering the Paradise. On the other hand, disobedience

to the Nabi Karim ﷺ has been described as the cause of failure and a reason due to which a person will be sent to hell.

Hence, obedience to the Nabi Karim's ﷺ instructions and abiding by his judgements is the basic condition of faith. The Nabi Karim ﷺ has explained in his sayings that no one can be a believer until he loves The Nabi Karim ﷺ more than his parents, children and rest of the people. He further said that no one can be a true believer until he turns his wishes according to the instructions brought by The Nabi Karim ﷺ. This means that faith cannot be complete without obeying The Nabi Karim ﷺ. Therefore, it is necessary for a Muslim to obey Almighty Allah along with the Nabi Karim ﷺ because his life is a role model for us. As the Holy Quran states:

لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ

Translation: You have indeed, in the life of the *Rasool-ul-Allah*, the best example.
[Surah Al-Ahzab: 21]

Obedience to the Nabi Karim ﷺ and the Companions رضی اللہ عنہم: Almighty Allah chose great people for the Nabi Karim ﷺ to become his Companions رضی اللہ عنہم who feel pleased to sacrifice their lives for every single act and word of the Nabi Karim ﷺ. The Companions رضی اللہ عنہم followed the Nabi Karim ﷺ in all matters of life. They considered the obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ as their purpose of life. The Companions رضی اللہ عنہم of the Nabi Karim ﷺ followed his footsteps in each and every matter of their lives, including eating, drinking, sitting, walking, sleeping, socializing etc.

The Companions رضی اللہ عنہم of the Nabi Karim ﷺ were extremely concerned and attentive about the obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ. Once, the Nabi Karim ﷺ was sitting on the pulpit for delivering the Friday sermon. He asked some of the Companions رضی اللہ عنہم to sit down. At that time, Abdullah bin Masood رضی اللہ عنہ was entering from the gate of the *Masjid*. When he heard these words, he immediately sat down there at the entrance of the *Masjid* so that he would not disobey the order of the Nabi Karim ﷺ. When the Nabi Karim ﷺ asked him to come forward, he got up and came forward. From this it can be assessed that how much concluded and practical the Companions رضی اللہ عنہم were about obeying the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ.

It is learnt from this unit that

Obedience to the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ means following and obeying him in every matter of life. It is not possible to understand and follow all the commands given in the Holy Quran without obeying the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ. The life of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ serves as the best example of action for Muslims. His obedience leads to the success of both the worlds i.e., this world and the Hereafter, while his disobedience means failure in this world and the Hereafter.

Activity for the students

Make a chart of Quranic Ayaat and *Ahadith* related to the obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ and display it in your classroom.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. What is meant by obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ (*Ita'at-e-Rasool*)?
2. Write down the importance of obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ (*Ita'at-e-Rasool*) in your own words.
3. Describe the conduct of the Companions رضى الله عنهم about obedience of the Nabi Karim ﷺ.
4. What is essential for the success in both the worlds?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Allah Almighty revealed the following book on The Nabi Karim ﷺ:

(A) The Torah (Old Testament)	(B) The Injeel (New Testament)
(C) The Zabur (Psalms)	(D) The Holy Quran
2. For the success of this world and the Hereafter, it is necessary to follow:

(A) Angels	(B) Unseen creatures
(C) The Nabi Karim ﷺ	(D) Leaders
3. Obedience means:

(A) To show patience	(B) To tolerate
(C) To obey and follow (<i>Ita'at</i>)	(D) To be stingy
4. Those who always followed the footsteps of The Nabi Karim ﷺ in each and every matter are called:

(A) Disbelievers	(B) Jews
(C) Hypocrites	(D) Companions رضى الله عنهم of The Nabi Karim ﷺ

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. '*Ita'at*' is a word of _____ language.
2. The Nabi Karim's ﷺ _____ is role model for us.
3. The Nabi Karim's ﷺ obedience is necessary for the success of this world and _____.

4. To decide and act according to the decision of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ is an essential condition of _____.
5. Our _____ does not complete without the obedience of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

4. Match the words in column 1 with appropriate words in column 2 to complete the sentences:

Column 1
1. The one who will obey The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
2. Allah's pleasure is only in
3. Believers! Obey Allah Almighty

Column 2
following the way of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
and His <i>Rasool</i>
will enter Paradise.

Instructions for the teachers

Organise a speech competition in your school on the topic 'Obedience to the Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ.'

The Importance of the *Sunnah* of the Nabi Karim ﷺ

Learning Outcomes

After studying this unit, students will be able to:

- ❖ Describe the meaning of the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ.
- ❖ Write about the importance of the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ.

Sunnah: 'سُنَّتْ' (*Sunnah*) literally refers to a path and a way to do something. The Nabi Karim's ﷺ *Sunnah* means, the way of the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ, which reached to us in the form of his recorded actions and deeds. Allah conveyed his message to The Nabi Karim ﷺ through revelation, for the guidance of His servants, and the *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ not only conveyed the message to the people, but also interpreted it and demonstrated it through his actions. That is why Allah has declared the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ as the best example for people. Allah says in the Quran:

لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ

Translation: Verily, you have in *Rasool-ul-Allah* ﷺ a good model.
[Surah Al-Ahzab: 33-21]

The Pillars of Islam and the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ: The Holy Quran orders the believers to establish the pillars of Islam, however, the complete explanation of establishing them is obtained from the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. *Namaz* (*Salat*) is the most important among the pillars of Islam. Multiple Ayaat of the Holy Quran order the believers to establish *Namaz*, but the method of performing the *Namaz*, the number of rakats, and the timings of the *Namaz* are not mentioned in the Holy Quran. In this regard, we get guidance from the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. The Nabi Karim ﷺ taught the method of *Namaz* by practically demonstrating it. Then, he instructed that:

Translation: Offer *Namaz* the way you see me offering it.

Similarly, *Zakat* (Charity) is also an important pillar of Islam. Paying of *Zakat* has been repeatedly emphasized in the Quran. But, the *Nisab* (standard) of *Zakat*, the rate of *Zakat*, the time of *Zakat* and other details are explained by the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. The obligation of *Saum* in the month of Ramadan is ordered in the Holy Quran, but we have to refer to the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ for the rulings and problems related to *Saum*. Hajj is also an important pillar of Islam. The command to perform it is in the Quran, however, we acquired the details of the rules of Hajj from the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. On the occasion of the farewell Hajj (*Hajjat-ul-Wida*), the Nabi Karim ﷺ said:

Translation: Learn properly, the rules and method of performing Hajj from me.

In the same way, there are other Islamic commandments which are given in the Holy Quran, but we get the details and methods of performing them from the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. This means that the complete guidance regarding all the acts of worship and other commandments for the Muslims are found in the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ.

The Nabi Karim's ﷺ *Sunnah* is the Role Model: Allah has made the personality of the Nabi Karim ﷺ comprehensive, perfect and universal. He was a ruler, businessman and also did labour work. He had also seen the sufferings of war and also has been a successful army commander, a judge, a teacher, a husband and a father. In every case, he left the best example for the Ummah. There is a practical example in the life of the Nabi Karim ﷺ for every person in the world who belongs to any field of life. Whatever the Nabi Karim ﷺ ordered, he himself did that practically to set an example for others. In the whole history of humankind, The Nabi Karim ﷺ is the only person, whose details, even minute ones, are preserved in the Holy Quran, *Ahadith* and *Seerah*. Furthermore, all the people until the Day of Resurrection will continue to receive guidance from it.

We are fortunate that we have the guidance of The Nabi Karim ﷺ from domestic affairs to the global affairs. If it were not so, today we would be wandering astray. Following the *Sunnah* of the Nabi Karim ﷺ is very important. If we follow the *Sunnah* of the The Nabi Karim ﷺ, we will certainly be successful in this world and the hereafter.

It is learnt from this unit that

The Nabi Karim's ﷺ actions and deeds are called the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ is a practical explanation of the commands of Allah. Muslims have been emphasised to follow the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. Every person can get guidance from the life of The Nabi Karim ﷺ. The success in this World and the Hereafter depends on following the *Seerah* (life) of the Nabi Karim ﷺ.

Activity for the students

Students need to write the following Quranic Ayat with translation on a chart, in a beautiful style and hang it on the wall of their classroom.

لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What is meant by the *Sunnah* of the Nabi Karim ﷺ?
2. What is the importance of *Sunnah* regarding *Namaz* (Prayer)?
3. What was said by The Nabi Karim ﷺ about the method of Hajj (Pilgrimage)?
4. Whose life has Allah declared 'a pattern of action' for people?
5. Write translation of a Ayat of the Quran about the importance of the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ?

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. *Saum* is obligatory in the month of:

(A) Shaban	(B) Ramadan
(C) Shawal	(D) Dhu Al-Hijah
2. The *Sunnah* of the Holy Prophet in Islam means:

(A) The way of Hazrat Ibrahim عليه السلام	(B) The way of Hazrat Musa عليه السلام
(C) The way of Hazrat Isa عليه السلام	(D) The way of the Nabi Karim ﷺ
3. The details of performing Hajj are mentioned in:

(A) In Torah (Old Testament)	(B) In Zabur (Psalms)
(C) In Injeel (New testament)	(D) In the <i>Sunnah</i> of the Nabi Karim ﷺ
4. The way of success in this World and the Hereafter is:

(A) Excess of wealth	(B) Excess of children
(C) Health	(D) To follow the <i>Sunnah</i> of the Nabi Karim ﷺ

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. Allah has made the personality of The Nabi Karim ﷺ comprehensive, perfect and _____.
2. The most important pillar among the pillars of Islam is _____.
3. Whatever The Nabi Karim ﷺ ordered the Muslims, he himself _____ upon it first.
4. Hajj is one of the _____ of Islam.
5. For explanation about the rulings and problems related to *Saum*, we need to look into the _____.

4. Tick (✓) the right answer and cross (✗) the wrong answer:

Sentence	Right	Wrong
1. حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ is the last <i>Rasool-ul-Allah</i> .	☐	☐
2. Allah revealed Zabur (Psalms) upon Hazrat Musa عليه السلام.	☐	☐
3. The Nabi Karim's صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ life is the best practical example to be followed.	☐	☐
4. <i>Saum</i> is the most important pillar, among the pillars of Islam.	☐	☐

Instructions for the teachers

In order to inculcate the adoration of the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ among the students, describe the examples of the Companions رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ and explain how they acted upon the *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

Introduction and Social Importance of Friday and Eids

Learning Outcomes

After studying this unit, students will be able to:

- ❖ Write the introduction of Friday and Eid *Namaz*.
- ❖ Describe the commandments and manners related to Friday and Eid *Namaz*.
- ❖ Write about the Social importance of Friday and Eid *Namaz*.

Introduction and Importance of Friday *Namaz*

It is obligatory on Muslims to offer Friday *Namaz*. It cannot be missed without any genuine and legitimate excuse, which is acceptable in *Shariah* (*Uzr-e-Shrai*). It is offered in congregation at the time of *Zuhr Namaz*. An *Adhan* (call for *Namaz*) is called before the sermon. After the *Adhan*, Imam (leader) of the congregation delivers two sermons. In the sermons, glorification and praise of Allah, blessings and peace upon The Nabi Karim ﷺ

وَعَلَىٰ آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, obedience to him, and lessons regarding virtues, goodness and good social relations are imparted. In the end of the sermons, the Imam also prays for the pious and saintly Muslims who left this world before us. After the sermon, two Rakat of *Namaz* are offered in congregation. Allah has emphasised about the Friday *Namaz* in following Ayat of the Holy Quran:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِذَا نُودِيَ لِلصَّلَاةِ مِنْ يَوْمِ الْجُمُعَةِ فَاسْعَوْا إِلَىٰ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ وَذَرُوا الْبَيْعَ

Translation: O Believers! When the call to *Namaz* is made on Friday (the day of congregation), hasten to the remembrance of God, and leave all worldly commerce (business), this is better for you, if you have knowledge. [Surah Al-Jumua: 9]

Etiquette of Friday *Namaz*:

- One should go to the Masjid for Friday *Namaz* after taking bath, wearing new or neat & clean clothes and applying good fragrance.
- One should go to the Masjid earlier because the first one to reach the Masjid for Friday *Namaz* gets the reward of scarifying a camel in the way of Allah.
- One should sit wherever he finds place in the Masjid. It is not right to jump over people's necks and go ahead or make someone leave their place for you.
- Imam delivers a sermon before the *Namaz* which must be listened to, quietly and attentively.

Social Significance of Friday:

Islam is a social religion which recommends the Muslims to live in a united manner. So, it has kept collectiveness in its worship system and has given great importance to a communal approach of worship. The main purpose of collective *Namaz* is that Muslims should live together and get to know about each other's problems. Islam also wants the mutual relations of Muslims to be pleasant, filled with spirit of sympathy, love and cooperation. Hence, all the worships of Islam teach mutual connection, relationship and discipline. Friday *Namaz* is the best example of this collective approach.



Introduction and Importance of Eid Festivals:

Every religion and society of the world has some specific days of festival in which they celebrate happiness. When The Nabi Karim ﷺ migrated from *Makkah* and came to *Madinah*, the local people there used to celebrate two days of festival on annual basis. Hence, Allah also granted Muslims two days in a year to celebrate Eid (Happiness). The first one is Eid-ul-Fitr and the other is Eid-ul-Adha. These days provide Muslims an opportunity to thank Allah on one hand and socialize with each other and help the needy on the other hand. On the occasion of these Eids, the collective life of Muslims is practically demonstrated.

Eid-ul-Fitr: Eid-ul-Fitr is celebrated on the 1st day of the month of Shawwal, in celebration of the accomplishment of the fasts of Ramadan. Allah Almighty has ordered the Muslims to share their happiness with other Muslims by providing financial support to their needy brothers on the occasion of Eid-ul-Fitr. For this purpose, Allah has made Sadaqah Al-Fitr (*Fitrana*) obligatory on wealthy Muslims, which they pay on behalf of themselves and their dependents. On one hand, *Fitrana* is an atonement for the deficiencies, which occurred during the *Saum*, while on the other hand, it helps the poor and needy people, financially. Sadaqah Al-Fitr is given before the Eid-ul-Fitr *Namaz* so that the poor and needy people can also share the joys of Eid.

Eid-ul-Adha: Eid-ul-Adha is celebrated on the 10th day of the month of Dhu Al-Hijjah. In fact, this Eid is celebrated to commemorate the great sacrifice of Hazrat Ibrahim عليه السلام which he offered for Allah. After the Eid-ul-Adha *Namaz*, halal animals are sacrificed for Allah. This sacrifice is a declaration by the Muslims that their lives, wealth and everything is for Allah and they are always ready to sacrifice all of them before Him. Animal Sacrifice is obligatory on every Muslim who has the wealth and ability to do it. It means, to own the wealth which is at least equal to the *Nisab* of *Zakat*. The sacrificial meat is eaten by the Muslims themselves and distributed among their relatives, friends, the poor and needy. It also increases mutual brotherhood and compassion.

Manners of Celebrating Eid:

- It is *Sunnah* of The Nabi Karim ﷺ to bath (perform *Ghusl*), wear clean and good clothes and apply good fragrance before the Eid *Namaz*.
- Following *Takbir* are recited while going for Eid *Namaz* and returning after performing them:

الله اكبر الله اكبر لا اله الا الله والله اكبر الله اكبر والله الحيد

Translation: Allah is the Greatest. Allah is the Greatest. There is none worthy of worship except Allah, and Allah is the Greatest, Allah is the Greatest and all the praises are due to Allah alone.

- Separate routes should be taken for going to the *Eid-Gah* (ground or an open area for offering Eid *Namaz*) and returning back home after performing the *Namaz*.
- The Eid *Namaz* is offered after the Sun has fully risen. It consists of two Rakats and additional *Takbeers* than usual *Namaz* are recited in it.
- Imam delivers a sermon (*Khutba*) after the Eid *Namaz*, in which the teachings of Islamic brotherhood, compassion, and sacrifice are highlighted after praising Allah and sending Durood to Nabi Karim ﷺ



Eidgah, Hyderabad

اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. Performance of good deeds and fear of Allah Almighty is encouraged. It is necessary to listen to the sermon quietly and attentively.

Social Importance of Eids: Both the Eids have great social significance in the Muslim community, because in the five-time daily *Namaz*, only Muslims of a neighbourhood meet each other, during Friday *Namaz* Muslims from more than one neighbourhood or the whole town meet together, while in Eid *Namaz*, not only the people from the neighbourhood, but from the whole town and from its outskirts get together. Such huge gatherings of Muslims, on one hand, display unity, discipline and manpower of the Muslims, while on the other hand they exhibit an expression of love, affection and sympathy among the Muslims.

On the occasions of Eid, all men, women, children, old people wear neat and clean clothes, shake hands and hug each other, which double their happiness. According to the commandments of Islam, Muslims who are wealthy and able, pay *Fitrana* and offer sacrifice, which helps the poor and needy financially. In this way, the rich and the poor share the happiness and thus, present a good example of fraternity and brotherhood.

It is learnt from this unit that

- Friday *Namaz* is obligatory for the Muslims and it is offered in congregation at the time of Zuhri *Namaz*.
- Allah has emphasised in the Holy Quran about offering Friday *Namaz*.
- Eid-ul-Fitr and Eid-ul-Adha are two annual occasions of celebration for the Muslims. They wear new or neat & clean clothes on these occasions and gather in *Eid-Gah* (Ground where Eid *Namaz* offered) to offer gratitude to Allah for His blessings and to meet each other.

Activity for the students

- Students need to write in detail about the activities which take place on Friday from the Adhan till offering the Friday *Namaz*, and discuss them.
- How do you celebrate Eids? Tell your friends.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. What are the objectives of congregational *Namaz*?
2. Write down an introduction to Friday *Namaz*?
3. Describe etiquettes of Friday *Namaz*?
4. Write about social significance of Eid festivals.
5. Write about manners of Eid *Namaz*.

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. Friday *Namaz* is offered:

- (A) At the time of Fajr
(C) At the time of Asr

- (B) At the time of Zuhri
(D) At the time of Isha

2. Number of obligatory Rakats in Friday *Namaz* are:

- (A) Two
(C) Four

- (B) Three
(D) Six

3. Eid-ul-Fitr is celebrated on:

- (A) 1st of Shaban
(C) 1st of Shawwal

- (B) 1st of Ramadan
(D) 10th of Dhu Al-Hijah

4. Eid-ul-Adha is celebrated in remembrance of the sacrifice of Prophet:

(A) Hazrat Ibrahim عليه السلام

(B) Hazrat Nooh عليه السلام

(C) Hazrat Moosa عليه السلام

(D) Hazrat Isa عليه السلام

3. Fill in the blanks.

1. Friday *Namaz* cannot be missed without any _____.
2. The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ has declared that _____ is the best day of week.
3. _____ are scarified on Eid-ul-Adha.
4. Eid-ul-Adha is celebrated on the 10th of _____.

4. Match the words in column 1 with appropriate words in column 2 to complete the sentences:

Column 1	Column 2
1. Friday <i>Namaz</i> is offered at the time of Zuhr	Hazrat Ibrahim's عليه السلام great sacrifice
2. For Friday <i>Namaz</i> , one needs to take bath (<i>Ghusl</i>), wear new clothes,	to celebrate happiness and Eid
3. Allah has also given Muslims two days in a year	by helping them financially and sharing your happiness with them.
4. On the occasion of Eid-ul-Fitr, assist your needy brothers	apply good fragrance and then go to masjid
5. Eid-ul-Adha is celebrated in remembrance of	in congregation

Instructions for the teachers

- Inform students about the social significance of Friday and Eid *Namaz*, practically.
- Tell students about the meanings of genuine and legitimate excuse (Uzr-e-Sharai).

Introduction of *Saum* (Fasting) and its Significance

Learning Outcomes

After studying this unit, students will be able to:

- ❖ Tell the meaning of *Saum*
- ❖ State the commandments and manners of *Saum*.
- ❖ Write about the benefits of *Saum* and its spiritual and social significance.

Meaning of *Saum* (Fasting): Fasting is called '*Saum*' in Arabic, which literally means to stop, to prevent, to stay silent etc. *Saum* in Islam refers to abstaining from food, drink and carnal desires from dawn till sunset with the intention of seeking the pleasure of Allah. *Saum* is the fourth pillar of Islam and the third most important act of worship.

Obligation of *Saum*: *Saum* is obligatory on every sane and mature Muslim man and woman. Regarding the obligation of *Saum*, Allah Almighty states:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الصِّيَامُ كَمَا كُتِبَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ مِن قَبْلِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ

Translation: O Believers! *Saum* has been prescribed for you, just as it was prescribed for those before you, so that you may guard yourselves against evil. [Surah Al-Baqarah: 183]

In another Ayat, Allah Almighty states:

Translation: Therefore, he who witnesses this month, must fast in it (completely)...
[Surah Al-Baqarah:185]

The Nabi Karim ﷺ said:

Translation: Allah Almighty has made the fasts of the month of Ramadan obligatory upon you.

Importance and Merits of *Saum*: *Saum* is an important act of worship like *Namaz*. It is not only obligatory upon this nation (*Ummah*), but was also obligatory upon the earlier nations as well. The permission to leave fast has been given only to the sick people, the travellers and disabled people, but that too with the condition that as soon as the illness, journey or excuse ends, these people will have to keep the missed fasts.

While explaining about the merits of *Saum*, the Nabi Karim ﷺ said: "Whosoever fasts in the month of Ramadan with the intention of gaining faith and reward, all his/her past sins will be forgiven." *Saum* is the best way to abstain from sins. The Nabi Karim ﷺ has declared the month of Ramadan as the month of compassion and self-accountability. Another saying of the Nabi Karim ﷺ states that: 'This is the month of patience and the reward of patience is Paradise.' In this month, the sustenance of the believer is increased. In this month, the Holy Quran was revealed. In this month, *Laila-tul-Qadr* (Night of Power or Destiny) is kept, in which the reward of worship is more than a thousand months worship. In the month of Ramadan, the reward of performing one optional act of worship (*Nafil*) is equal to one obligatory act of worship (*Fard*) and the reward of performing one obligatory act of worship (*Fard*) is equal to performing seventy obligatory acts of worship (*Faraid*).



Dining Table during Iftar

Social Significance of *Saum*: *Saum* creates an environment of piety and self-control due to which good deeds increase and evil deeds decline, therefore, more good deeds are seen in the Muslim society during the month of Ramadan.

A person remains hungry and thirsty while *Saum*, from dawn to sunset, thus, he realises the feelings of the hungry and thirsty ones, and develops the sentiments of love, compassion and self-sacrifice for the deprived ones. This is the reason that more generosity and selflessness is seen in the month of Ramadan compared to other months. Due to *Saum*, the members of the society develop good qualities such as endurance, punctuality, avoidance of backbiting and piety, due to which an environment of order, peace and tranquillity is created in the society. During the month of Ramadan, Muslims frequently go to *Masjid* and become aware of each other's social problems and find solutions to them. Therefore, *Saum* has a great social significance.

Benefits of *Saum*:

- Due to *Saum*, a person is protected from small and big evils.
As the timings of starting the fast and breaking the fast are set, so the *Saum* person becomes punctual and disciplined in his/her life.
- Due to *Saum*, one's health improves and he/she is protected from many diseases.
Staying hungry and thirsty all day creates feelings of love and compassion for the poor and needy in the heart of a believer.
- Self-control and piety are developed in a believer by controlling hunger, thirst and other desires during *Saum*.
- Allah forgives previous sins of the person who fasts.

It is learnt from this unit that

- *Saum* is abstaining from food, drink and carnal desires from dawn to sunset with the intention of seeking the pleasure of Allah Almighty.
- *Saum* is obligatory on every Muslim and it has great significance in Islam.
- *Saum* helps a believer to understand the situation of hungry, thirsty and poor ones and encourages a person to be compassionate and help them.
- *Saum* is also a cure of many physical and spiritual diseases.

Activity for the students

Tell your class fellows about virtues, significance and benefits of *Saum*.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions.

1. What is meant by *Saum*?
2. Mention any Quranic Ayat which shows that the *Saum* is obligatory.
3. Write about social significance of *Saum* in your own words.
4. Briefly discuss the virtues of *Saum*.
5. Write about the benefits of *Saum*.

2. Tick '✓' the correct answer of the following:

1. *Saum* creates the following emotion for others:
(A) Compassion (B) Enmity
(C) Contempt (D) Jealousy

2. Literally 'Saum' means:

- (A) To show patience
- (C) To wait

- (B) To prevent
- (D) To give charity

3. The worship which Allah Almighty had made compulsory for previous nations is:

- (A) Charity
- (C) Alms giving (*Zakat*)

- (B) Pilgrimage (*Hajj*)
- (D) Fast

4. The Quran was revealed in:

- (A) Muharram
- (C) Ramadan

- (B) Rabi Al-Awwal
- (D) Dhu Al-Hijjah

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. *Saum* is called _____ in Arabic.
2. Allah forgives previous _____ of the one who fasts.
3. Majority of Muslims frequently go to _____ in the month of Ramadan.
4. *Saum* improves a person's health and saves him/her from many _____.
5. *Saum* is a good way to abstain from _____.

Instructions for the teachers

Organise a speech contest amongst the students on the benefits of *Saum*.

SEERAT-E-TAYYIBAH

حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
The Life of from Migration to *Madinah* to the Battle of Trench.

Introduction

‘Seerat’ means, a way, manner or path. ‘Tayyibah’ means pure. *Seerat-e-Tayyibah* refers to The Path or Way of Life which was adopted by the beloved nabi حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. The Nabi Karim’s صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ *Seerat-e-Tayyibah* is the only and consistent path that provides guidance in all spheres and domains of human life. His life is so perfect, inclusive and universal that people of all walks of life can find light and guidance from it, whether it is related to social and economic or political life sphere.

Objectives

The objectives of teaching these topics is that the students can become aware of the important events of The Nabi Karim’s صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ life and learn the importance of brotherhood and Charter of *Madinah*. They will learn the social significance of Masjid-e-Nabawi صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and causes as well as the objectives of the important *Ghazwats* (Battles). Students will also know how much The Nabi Karim صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and his Companions رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ sacrificed for the sake of Islam, what difficulties and problems they faced and how they remained steadfast and finally how they managed to succeed and propagate Islam to the people.